

Figure 5.9 *Bust, citadel and arch, general view from northeast. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

and perhaps even naturally protected on one flank by a river or cliff.[29] In the case of Bust, the layout followed the rising topography: two concentric enclaves were placed at the walled settlement's northwest corner, with the innermost enclave at a high promontory overlooking the town and plains below (Figures 5.8 and 5.9).[30] The enclosed enclaves decreased in accessibility, with the royal palace and other imperial machinery probably located within the highest and best protected area (Figure 5.9).

Understandably, both Bust and Lashkari Bazar had received lavish architectural attention from at least two of the great Ghaznavid sultans, Mahmud (r. AH 389–421/999–1030 CE) and his son Mas'ud I (r. AH 421–432/1030–1041 CE) during that dynasty's period of apogee. As these areas continued to play a significant role in the governance and control of Zamindawar and contiguous areas and byways, Mu'izz al-Din would have likely embarked on significant interventions there after the conquest of Ghazna in AH 569/1173 CE. But the nature of these interventions can only be tentatively understood with the currently available archaeological and other data. Further, based on the Shansabani patronage at Ghazna discussed previously – and on what we will see at Lashkari Bazar below – it is reasonable to propose that at Bust also, there was extensive reuse of the pre-existing Ghaznavid-era structures. New constructions were less frequent, however, as detailed forthwith.

The location of the mysterious "galleried" well within the upper enclave of the Bust citadel underscores this structure's importance (Figures 5.8, 5.10 and 5.11). Several of the well's seven stories were underground and led to a water catchment area.[31] However, no epigraphic finds or other chronological indicators have been associated with the structure, so that we can only conjecture as to its foundation date and period of use. While